2414

# Executive Order

## ALASKA RAILROAD NO. 6

Upon the recommendations of the Secretary of the Interior and of the Alaskan Engineering Commission, and under authority given in Act of Congress approved March 12, 1914 (38 Stat., 305) I hereby establish the following regulations for hospital service in connection with the construction and operation of the Government railway in Alaska:

The Alaskan Engineering Commission will under certain restrictions make no charge for the service of its medical or surgical officers for medical or surgical aid furnished to any employee injured or taken sick in Alaska, or medical or surgical aid furnished to any person, who, while under contract with the Commission, is injured or taken sick in Alaska, provided that at the time of such injury or inception of such sickness he be actually engaged in the work of construction of the Alaskan railways under contract with and under the supervision of said Commission, and that his injury or sickness occurs in the course of and arises out of such work.

The following benefits shall be furnished, subject to the regulations hereinafter laid down, namely:

a.—Hospital Service
b.—Medical and Surgical Treatment
c.—Medicines and Surgical Dressings
d.—Artificial Limbs and Eyes.

### Hospital Treatment.

Hospital treatment, under care of surgeons of the Commission will be provided at such hospitals as are now operated or may hereafter be operated by the Commission or at such hospitals as are or hereafter may be under contract with the Commission, to furnish such service.

Patients who require special care and nursing or who have not proper facilities at their homes for satisfactory treatment may be sent to hospital when deemed necessary by the attending physician. Board and nursing will not be furnished outside of hospital.

Patients should be discharged from hospital when in opinion of the surgeons in charge, they do not require further treatment there. Should patients insist upon remaining in hospital to save expense of board and lodging, when no longer requiring hospital treatment, surgeons will promptly refer the matter, with full particulars to the manager of the department in which the hospital is located.

### Medical and Surgical Treatment.

Medical and surgical treatment will be given employees and others under contract with the Commission, with the same consideration and care given private patients, and by a staff of surgeons provided by the Alaskan Engineering Commission.

These surgeons will render necessary treatment at any point within their districts, either at Commission or contract hospitals, at their offices, or at the homes of patients, as may be necessary. Patients or persons requiring continuous treatment, should when practicable, be sent to hospital. In cases of emergency, when for some sufficient reason the services of the Commis-

sion's surgeons are not available, first aid may be rendered by any available surgeon and the bill for such services rendered to the Commission. As soon as possible, the patient should be placed under the care of the surgeons regularly employed by the Commission. Patients wishing to consult other physicians other than those on the medical staff of the Commission will do so at their own expense unless such consultation is especially requested by the Commission's physicians.

MEDICINES AND SURGICAL DRESSINGS.

Medicines and surgical dressings will be provided at the various hospitals, for patients therein. Such supplies will be furnished for patients outside of hospitals, at all points where surgeons are located, when feasible. Reasonable bills for drugs and medicines, ordered by surgeons will be allowed. No prescriptions will be refilled except on written order from the physician.

ARTIFICIAL LIMBS AND APPLIANCES.

The Commission will furnish artificial limbs and eyes to those who have lost limbs or eyes, while in an accident which entitled them to surgical service. These articles will not be renewed. Crutches will be furnished as needed. When treatment ceases, these should be returned promptly. Eye glasses and spectacles will not be furnished.

SPECIAL RATES IN HOSPITALS FOR DEPENDENT MEMBERS OF FAMILIES.

The dependent members of an employee's family will be admitted as patients into the hospitals maintained by the Commission, and into contract hospitals, where feasible to arrange for same, on presenting a certificate signed by the head of the department in which employed; provided, that such accommodations are available after making provision for sick and injured employees. The accommodations furnished therein will be charged for at what they actually cost the Commission, and will cover board, lodging and nursing. Furthermore, in all such cases, the fees charged by the Commission's physicians for any service rendered, will be made very reasonable, so as to have this expense as little burdensome as possible to employees.

USE OF HOSPITAL BY PATIENTS NOT IN THE EMPLOY OF OR CONNECTED WITH THE COMMISSION OR OTHER BRANCHES OF THE GOVERNMENT SERVICE.

In localities where the Commission's hospital is the only hospital in good standing and possesses conveniences and appliances not available elsewhere, patients not connected with the work of the Commission may be admitted to the hospital. Provided, however, that they do not occupy room, or otherwise interfere with the service to be rendered to the Commission's employees. Such patients shall pay full hospital rates to be fixed by the official in charge of the district in which the hospital is located.

Any officials or employees of any department of the U. S. Government service, on duty in the vicinity of a Commission Hospital, or members of their families may be cared for in such hospitals under the rules regulating families of employees.

WHO WILL NOT BE GIVEN FREE MEDICAL OF SURGICAL TREATMENT.

Benefits will not be given for ailments due to venereal diseases, intemperance, vicious habits, injuries received in a fight or brawl, or unlawful

acts, nor for chronic diseases contracted before entering the employ of the Commission, nor for injuries sustained while not in actual service. In contagious diseases, treatment cannot be given in regular hospitals, but patients will be isolated, and treatment given, or will be turned over to the Federal quarantine officers. In cases of diphtheria, measles, scarlet fever and mumps, erysipelas, small-pox or whooping cough, owing to danger of these diseases spreading to other sick and injured employees in hospital, treatment shall as far as possible, be given at home, or at some proper place outside of hospital.

Consumptives, if disease is developed while employed by the Commission, will be given treatment outside the hospital, but will not be given hospital treatment, except at such points as the Commission may from time to time direct.

Insanity cases will be turned over to the territorial authorities.

Treatment for injury or sickness will continue as long as, in the opinion of the attending surgeon, it is necessary, but will not exceed four months continuous treatment at hospital or twelve months continuous treatment outside of hospital, except by special arrangement by the Commission.

Employees who abuse the benefits of the service, or flagrantly or persistently violate the regulations, will be excluded from further benefits of the service.

ORDERS FOR TREATMENT.

The Commissioner or other official in charge of any department of the Commission's work, shall designate whom he wishes to issue orders for medical or surgical treatment. A list of men, so designated shall be sent to all surgeons and to the Chairman of the Commission. An order signed by some one authorized to issue it, must be given, at the time his services are first required, to the surgeon, and a new order must be given to him each month thereafter, as long as treatment continues for that ailment or injury, unless the party is a patient in a hospital. If patient recovers from the ailment or injury for which order was issued, and requires treatment during same month or later, for another ailment, he must furnish a new order.

In case of serious accident or in emergency cases, telegraphic or other informal orders may be issued, but when an order is not secured at the time of first attention, it should be sent to surgeon as soon thereafter as possible. The surgeon shall after careful examination, decide whether patient had best be treated at hospital or receive outside treatment. If at hospital, an order should be issued by the surgeon to that effect, directed to the person in charge of the hospital.

MOVING THE INJURED OR SICK.

In case of serious injury or sickness where patients are to be sent to hospital, superintendents and foremen will see that they are transported there with all possible dispatch, and will arrange for competent attendant to accompany them when such is advisable, or will do so themselves if necessary.

APPLICANTS FOR EMPLOYMENT IN THE SERVICE OF THE COMMISSION.

All applicants for employment other than ordinary unskilled laborers and station men shall submit to physical examination by the examining

surgeons of the Commission, and those not in good physical condition to perform the duties of the position for which application is made, rejected. In case of unskilled labor and station men, the foreman or engineer in charge of the work on which applicant is to be engaged, should inquire carefully into his physical condition and state of health, and where he is manifestly suffering from some chronic ailment, his application should be rejected.

SANITARY CONDITIONS.

All surgeons will be expected to pay strict attention to sanitary conditions at all points of the work within their jurisdiction, or where employees live in large numbers, and to report at once to the Commission anything coming to their notice detrimental to the health of employees.

**WOODROW WILSON**

THE WHITE HOUSE,
*30 June, 1916.*

[No. 2414.]